Keynote Speaker

Professor Roger Dean

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Biography

Roger Dean is an Australian composer/ improviser, sound and multi-media artist. He has performed in more than 30 countries, as bassist, keyboardist, and lap-top computer artist. His compositions include computer and chamber music, to commissions from the Australian Chamber Orchestra, Sydney Alpha Ensemble, Wallace Collection and Chaconne Brass (UK) and others. His works are published by Open University (UK/USA), Red House, La Trobe University, and Sounds Australian, on cd-rom with the International Computer Music Association, and on the web (multimedia commissions from the Australian Film Commission, How2, and others).

His work is also available on more than 30 commercial recordings, including LPs/CDs on Audio Research Editions, Discus, Mosaic, Soma, Future Music Records (FMR) (UK); Jade, Rufus and Tall Poppies (Australia); and Crayon, Cuneiform, and Frog Peak (USA). He is developing computer-interactive networked improvisation, sound and intermedia work. He has published five books and many articles on improvisation, particularly in music, and on music cognition. With Hazel Smith he wrote Improvisation, Hypermedia and the Arts Since 1945 (Harwood, 1997). A subsequent book was on computer-interactive sound improvisation: Hyperimprovisation, published by A-R Editions (USA; with cd-rom, 2003). In 2005 he published Sounds from the Corner: Australian Jazz on CD (Australian Music Centre). His current research focuses on music cognition and computation.

He is the founder and director of austraLYSIS, the international sound and intermedia arts group (commenced as LYSIS, UK in 1970); and also founded the Sonic Communications Research Group at the University of Canberra. Roger has the unusual distinction of being a subject in both the new Grove Dictionary of Music and that of Jazz. He appears in an international group led by British jazz composer Graham Collier, and first recorded with him in 1975; a 2007 release is on Rune (USA). austraLYSIS regularly presents new work in Sydney and elsewhere, and its most recent CD is Sonic Stones (Tall Poppies, 2006). Dean was until early 2002 the founda-tion director of the Heart Research Institute, Sydney, and has more than 300 substantive scientific publications. From 2002-2007 he was the Vice-Chancellor and President of the University of Canberra. He is now a full time research professor in Sonic Communication at the MARCS Auditory Laboratories, University of Western Sydney. See www.australysis.com for information about his artistic work.